ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 16

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Pashto Alphabet

زما لومړنی پښتو کتاب

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 44 Pashto Letters with English Phonetics

ا ب پ ت ټ ث

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Pashto Alphabet — زما لومړنی پښتو کتاب

Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 16

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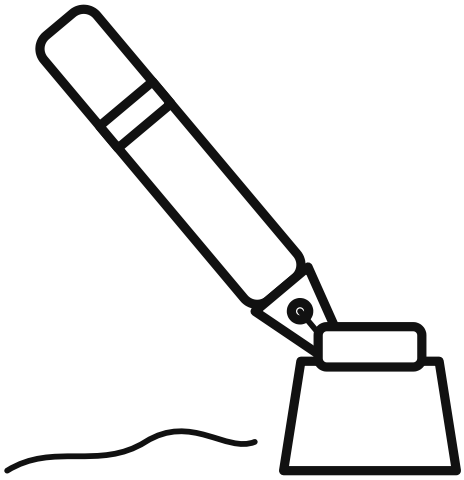
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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

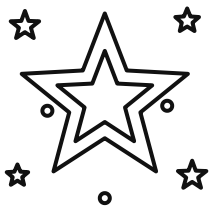
Fonts: Noto Sans Arabic, Noto Naskh Arabic, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

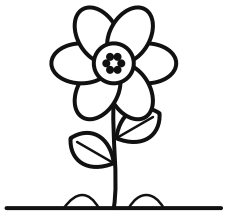


This book belongs to
دا کتاب زما دی

I started learning Pashto on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 16 is Pashto — the language of the mountains and valleys of Afghanistan and north-west Pakistan. More languages of the region are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Pashto is read from right to left**, like the Qur'an. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon". A short *a* in Pashto is often a quick, light 'uh' sound (as in "about").
- **A dot under t, d, r, n** (*ṭ, ḍ, ṛ, ṇ*) means a *hard* sound with the tongue curled back. In Pashto these letters wear a **little ring**: ټ ډ ړ ڼ.
- **Two ways to speak:** in the south (around Kandahar) ښ and ږ sound like a curled-back *sh* and *zh*; in the north-east (around Peshawar) they sound like *kh* and *g*. Both are right! This book shows the southern sound first and the other one in brackets.
- **Pashto has five letters for 'y' and 'e' sounds** (ي ې ۍ ی ئ). Most of them live at the end of words, so look carefully at the last letter!
- **Some letters sound the same** (ث س ص all say s; ذ ز ض ظ all say *z*). They keep their Arabic spelling, which helps when children later read the Qur'an.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Pashto name** written in Pashto (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. Because Pashto letters **change shape** when they join, the third box shows the letter at the start, middle and end of a word (letters that never join to the next letter are marked).

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard written Pashto as used in Afghanistan and Pakistan.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Pashto! پښتو

pashto — the Pashto word for the language

Who speaks it?
More than **40 million people** speak Pashto.[3]

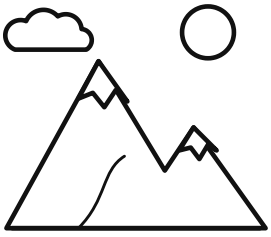
Where?
Pashto is one of the main languages of **Afghanistan**, and it is spoken by millions of people in north-west **Pakistan**, in cities such as Peshawar and Quetta. Pashto-speaking families live all over the world.

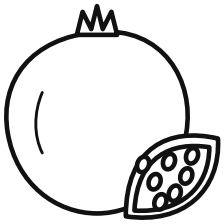
How is it written?
From **right to left**, in a Perso-Arabic script, in the clear upright style called **Naskh**. Most letters **join** to the next one and change shape.

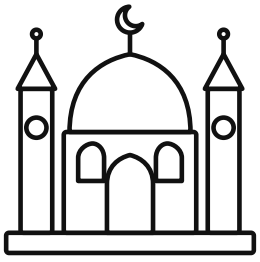
How many letters?
This book teaches **44 letters**. Pashto adds its own letters to the Arabic ones, such as ټ ډ ړ ڼ څ ځ ږ ښ ګ.

Rings and dots
Look for the **little rings** under ټ ډ ړ ڼ ګ and the extra dots on څ ږ ښ. They tell you the special Pashto sounds.

A friend of the Qur'an
Many Pashto words come from Arabic: قلم *qalam* (pen), کتاب *kitaab* (book), صبر *sabr* (patience).







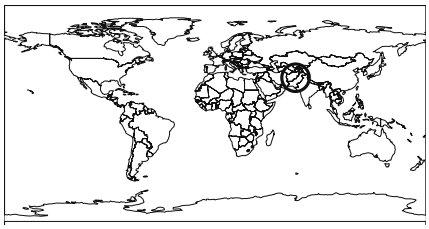
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Pashto Alphabet الفبا

44 letters — الفبا

چ *che*	ج *jeem*	ث *se*	ټ *ṭe*	ت *te*	پ *pe*	ب *be*	ا *alif*
ر *re*	ذ *zaal*	ډ *ḍaal*	د *daal*	ځ *dze*	څ *tse*	خ *khe*	ح *he*
ص *swaad*	ښ *ṣheen*	ش *sheen*	س *seen*	ږ *ẓe*	ژ *zhe*	ز *ze*	ړ *ṛe*
ک *kaaf*	ق *qaaf*	ف *fe*	غ *ghayn*	ع *ayn*	ظ *zoy*	ط *toy*	ض *zwaad*
ي *maaroofa ye*	ه *he*	و *waaw*	ڼ *ṇoon*	ن *noon*	م *meem*	ل *laam*	ګ *gaaf*
				ئ *feli ye*	ے *shadzeena ye*	ی *narma ye*	ې *majhoola ye*

Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Afghanistan and Pakistan on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Pashto spoken?



Color it: the area inside the dashed line **yellow** · the rest of the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Kabul ★ is the capital of Afghanistan. Pashto is spoken in Kabul and Kandahar, and in Peshawar and Quetta in Pakistan. Draw the high mountains with snowy tops!

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THE LETTERS

The Pashto Letters الفبا

alifbaa — “the a-b-c”

Pashto is written **from right to left**. Open your book at any letter page and start reading on the right!

Letters hold hands

Most Pashto letters **join** to the letter after them, and their shape changes a little at the start, middle and end of a word. Each letter page shows all three shapes.

ق + ل + م = قلم

q + l + m = qalam (pen)

Rings make hard sounds

A little ring changes a letter:

ت ← ټ د ← ډ ر ← ړ ن ← ڼ

from the right: t → ṭ · d → ḍ · r → ṛ · n → ṇ

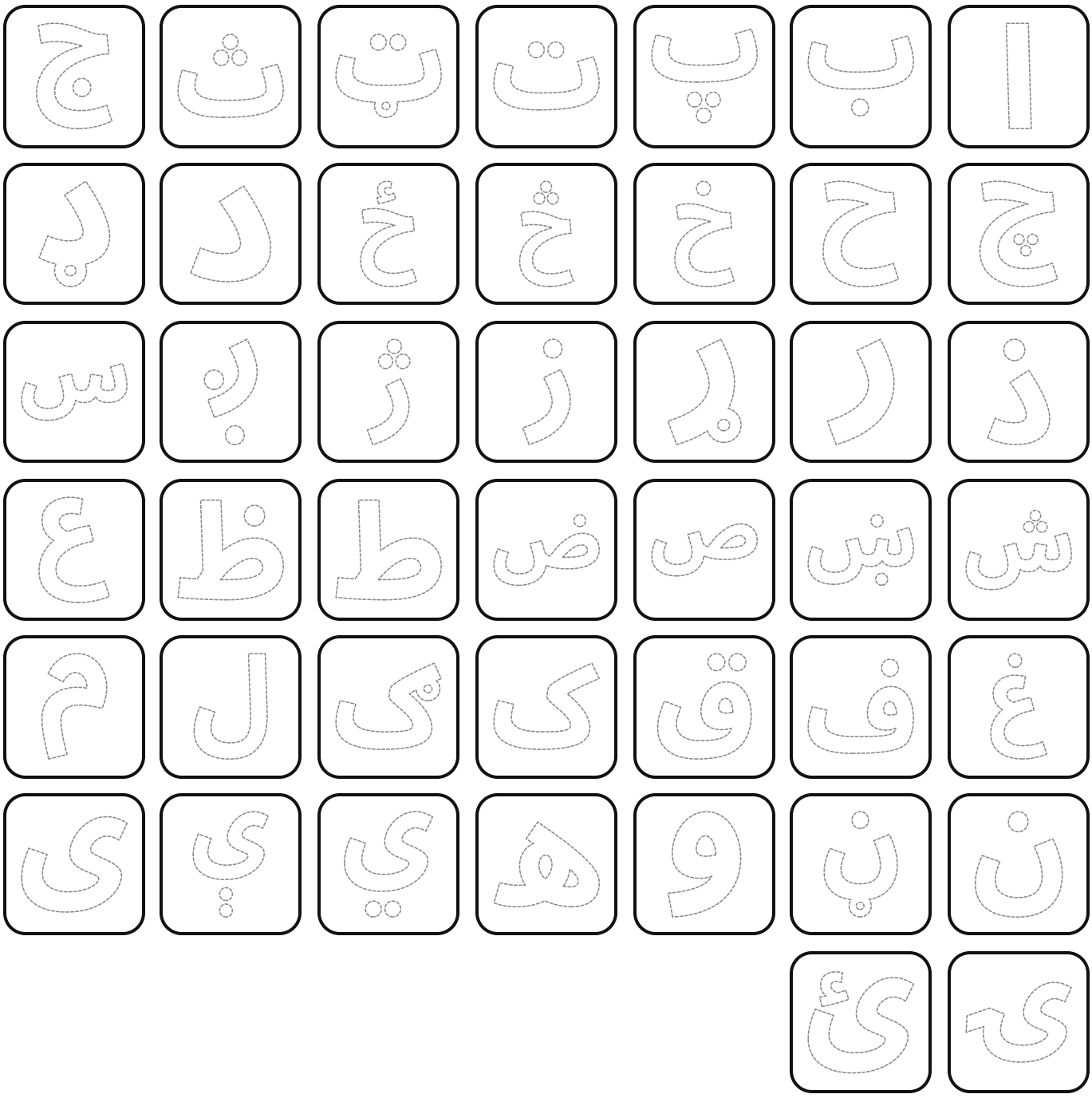
Eleven letters never join forward

ا د ډ ذ ر ړ ز ژ ږ و ی join to the letter *before* them, but never to the one after. Look for the small note on their pages.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters الفبا

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ا

NAME · نوم

الف

alif

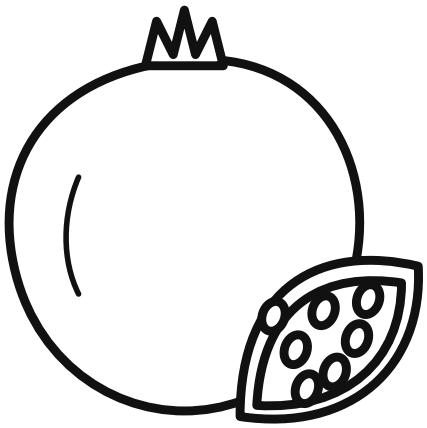
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’, or a long ‘aa’ as in “father” inside a word

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ا · after a letter ـا

It never joins to the letter after it.



ا IS FOR

انار

anaar

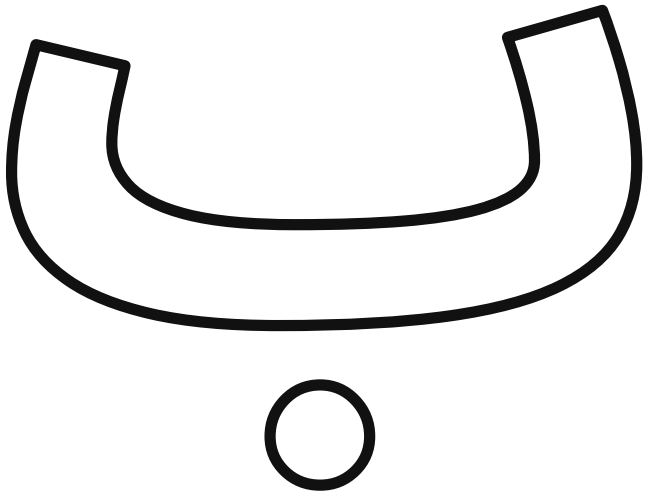
pomegranate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ا ا ا ا ا ا

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NAME · نوم

بې

be

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

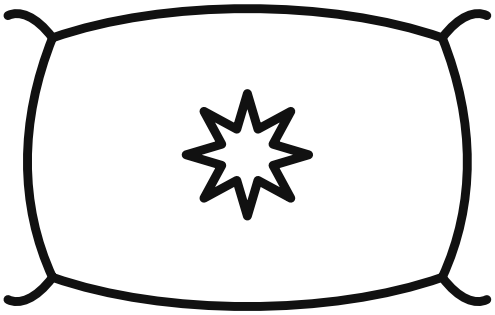
‘b’ as in “ball”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

بـ ـبـ ـب

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

One dot below.



ب IS FOR

بالښت

baalisht

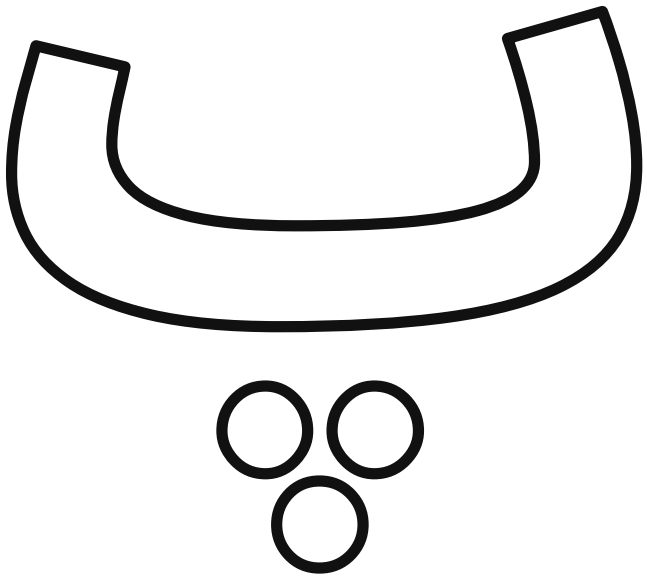
pillow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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پ

pe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

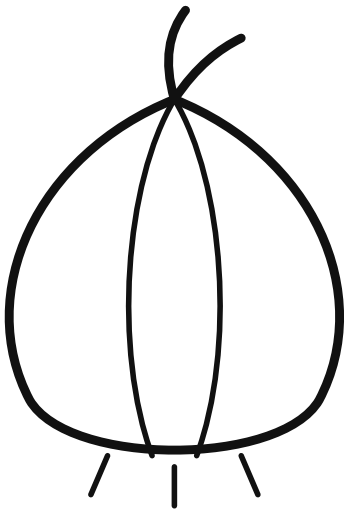
‘p’ as in “pen”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

پـ ـپـ ـپ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Three dots below.



پ IS FOR

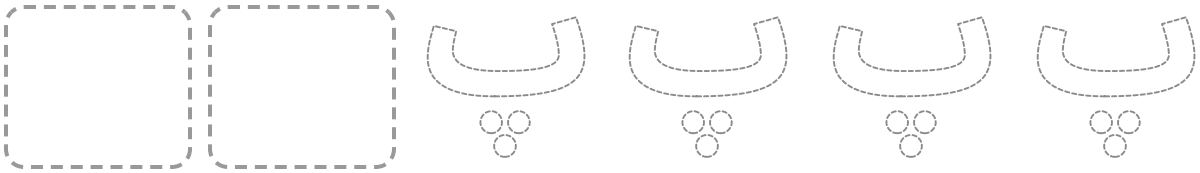
پیاز

pyaaz

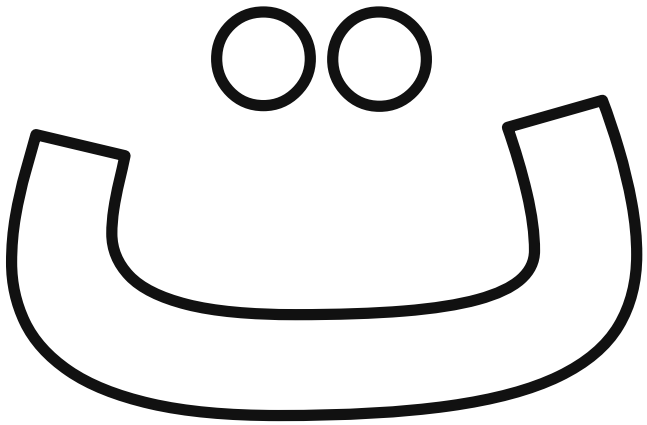
onion

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ



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SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

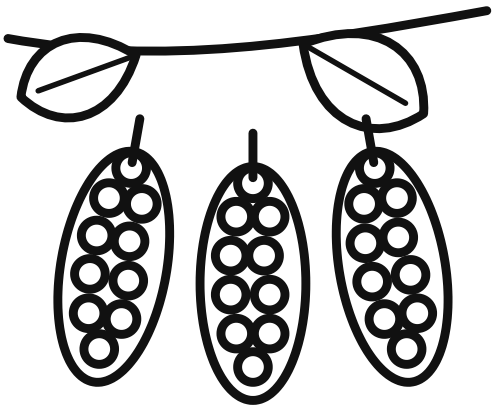
a soft ‘t’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

تـ ـتـ ـت

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Two dots above.



ت IS FOR

توت

toot

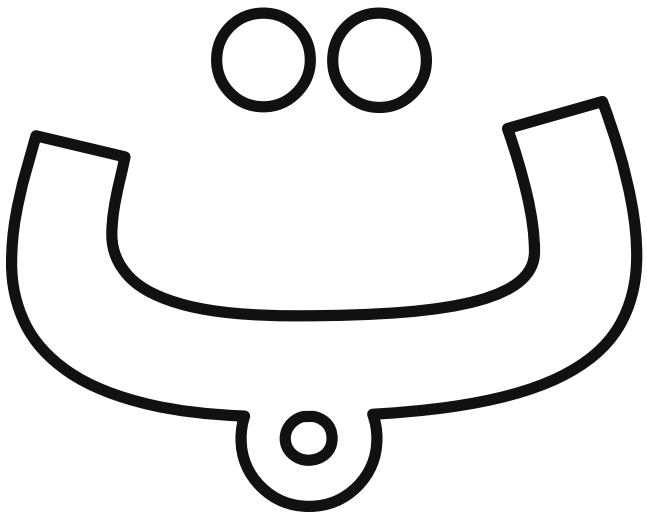
mulberry

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ



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SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

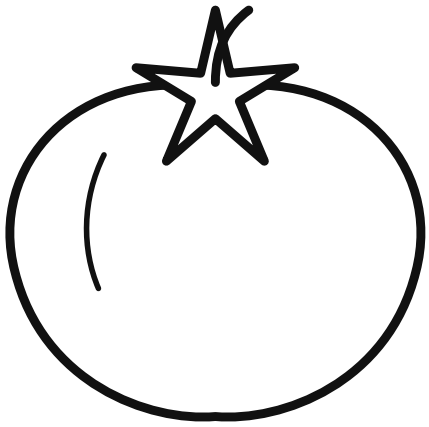
a hard ‘t’ — curl your tongue back, as in “top”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ټـ ـټـ ـټ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

The little ring under it means the tongue curls back.



ټ IS FOR

ټماټر

ṭamaaṭar

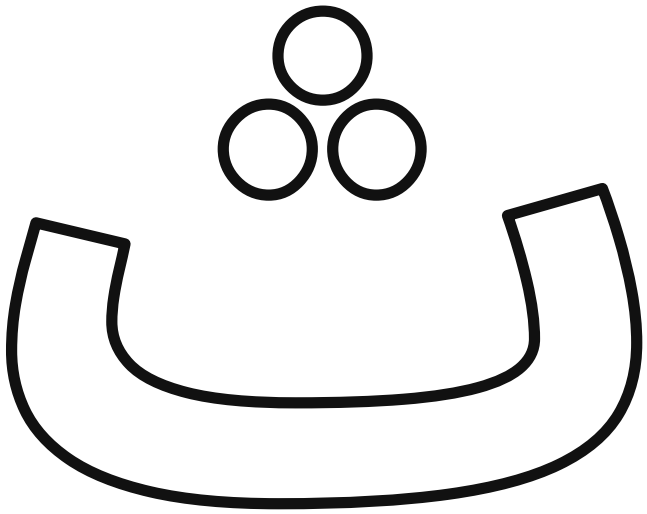
tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ



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NAME · نوم

ثې

se

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ثـ ـثـ ـث

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as س; it is used mostly in words from Arabic.



ث IS FOR

ثمر

samar

fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ث ث ث ث

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ج

NAME · نوم

جیم

jeem

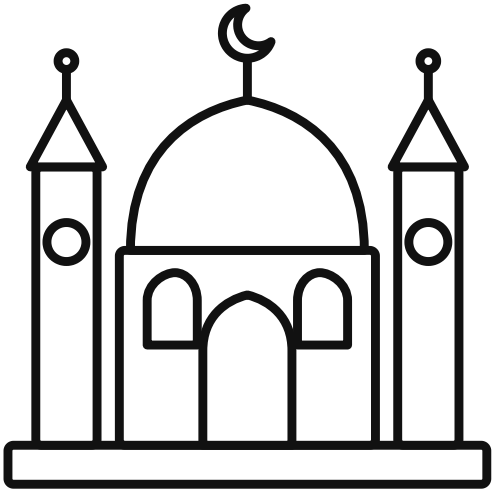
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

جـ ـجـ ـج

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ج IS FOR

جومات

jumaat

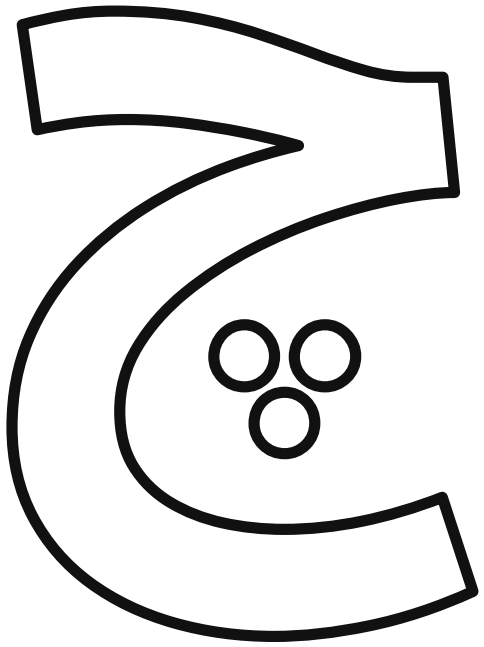
mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ

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NAME · نوم

چې

che

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

چ ـچـ ـچ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



چ IS FOR

چتر

chatr

umbrella

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

چ چ چ چ

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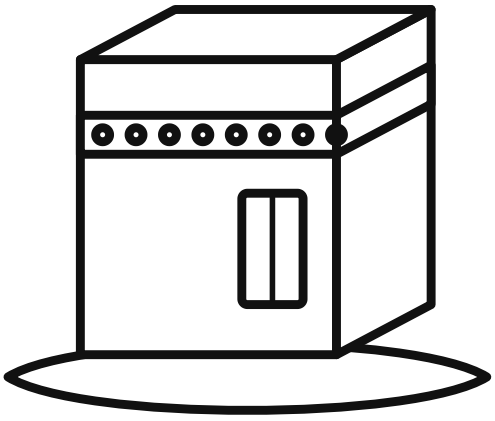
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'h' as in "hat"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ح ـحـ ـح

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ح IS FOR

حج

hajj

Hajj, the journey to the Kaaba in Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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NAME · نوم

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khe

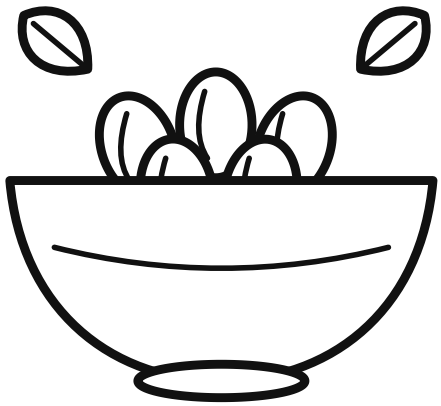
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a scratchy ‘kh’ from the back of the throat, as in Scottish “loch”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

خ ـخـ ـخ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



خ IS FOR

خرما

khurmaa

dates

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

خ خ خ خ

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NAME · نوم

څې

tse

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

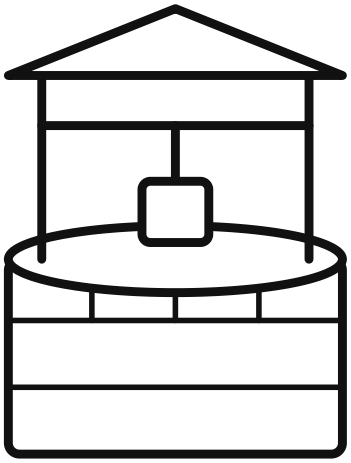
‘ts’ as in “cats”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

څ ـځـ ـځ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Three dots above.



څ IS FOR

څاه

tsaah

well (for water)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ځ ځ ځ ځ

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dze

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

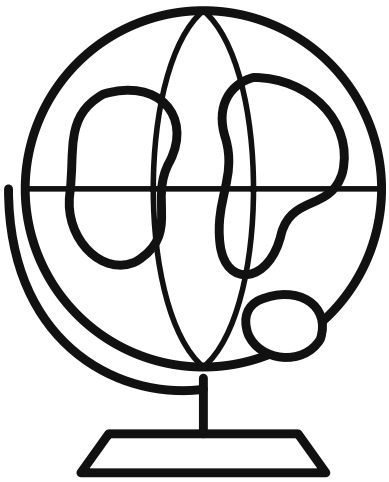
‘dz’ as in “kids” (some people say ‘z’)

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ځ ـځـ ـځ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A little hamza on top.



ځ IS FOR

ځمکه

dzmaka

the Earth

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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دال

daal

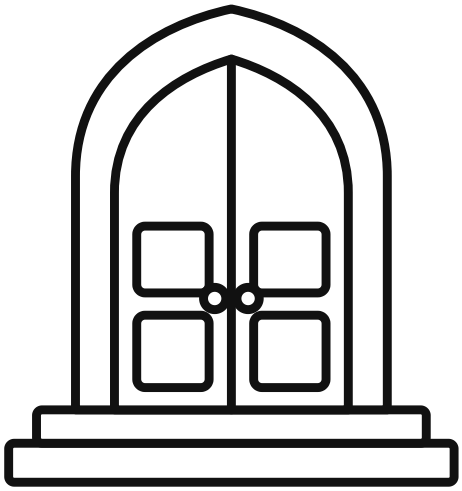
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone د · after a letter ـد

It never joins to the letter after it.



د IS FOR

دروازه

darwaaza

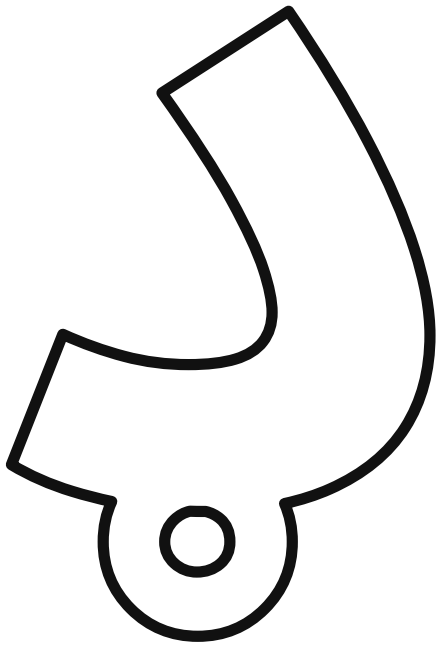
door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

د د د د

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ḍaal

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘d’ — curl your tongue back, as in “dog”

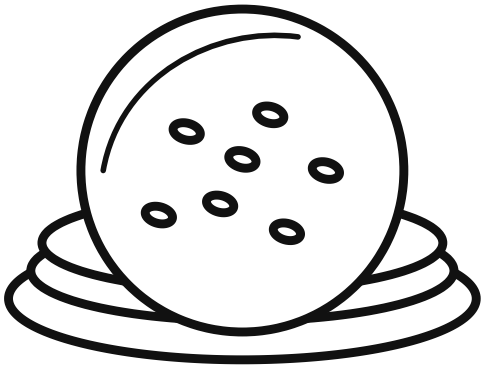
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ډ · after a letter ـډ

It never joins to the letter after it.

The little ring under it means the tongue curls back.

ډ IS FOR



ډوډۍ

ḍoḍay

bread

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ



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ذ

NAME · نوم

ذال

zaal

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

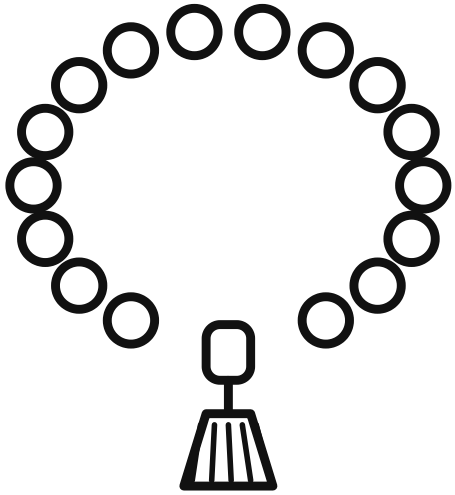
‘z’ as in “zoo”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ذ · after a letter ـذ

It never joins to the letter after it.

Sounds the same as ز; it is used mostly in words from Arabic.



ذ IS FOR

ذکر

zikr

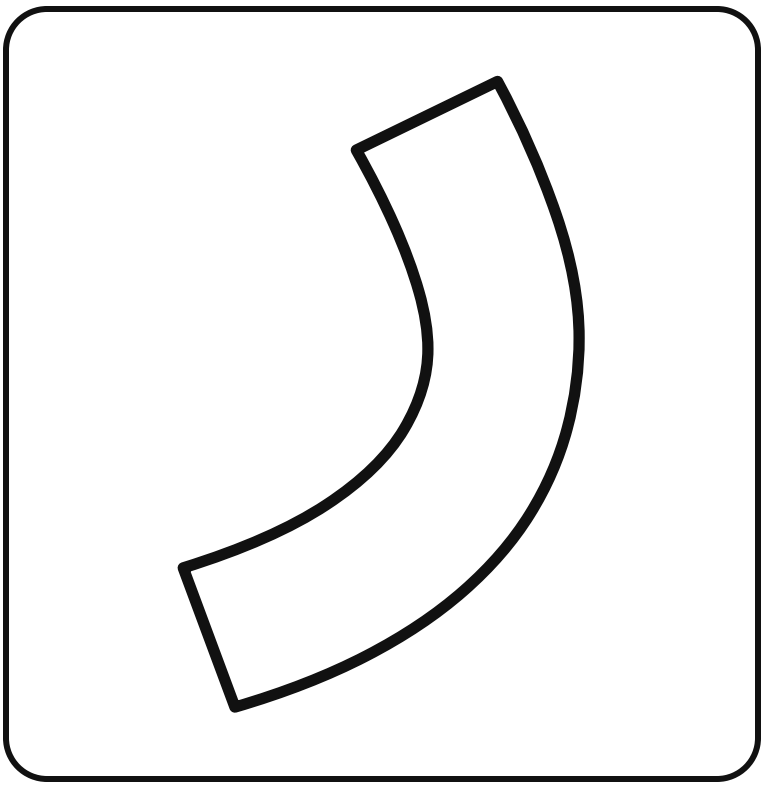
dhikr — remembering Allah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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re

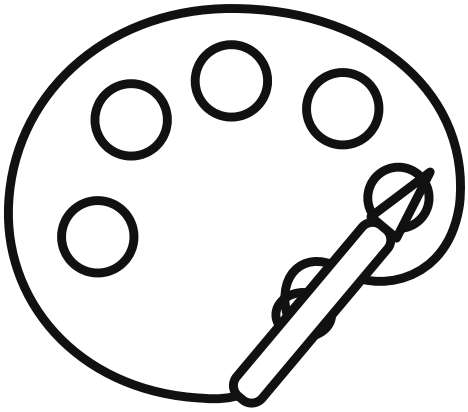
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ر · after a letter ـر

It never joins to the letter after it.



ر IS FOR

رنګ

rang

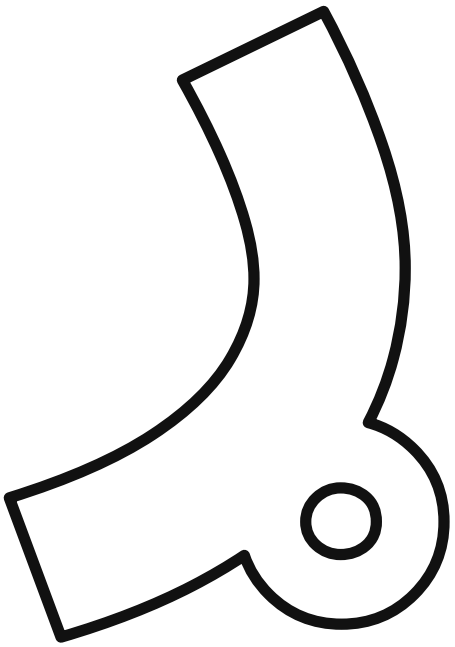
colour

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

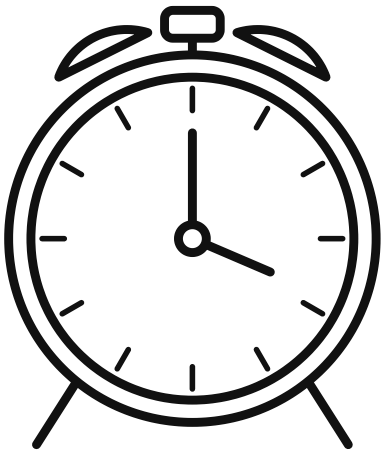
a flapped ‘r’ with the tongue curled back — it never starts a word

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ړ · after a letter ـړ

It never joins to the letter after it.

Find ړ in the middle of ګړی!



ړ IS FOR

ګړی

gaṛay

clock, watch

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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ze

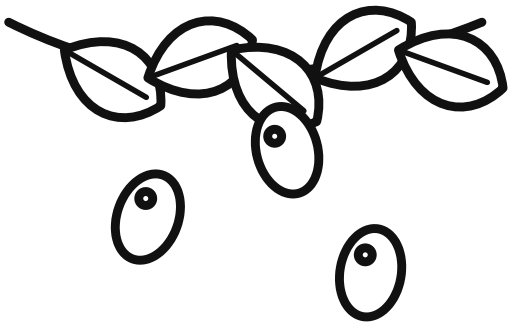
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **ز** · after a letter **ـز**

It never joins to the letter after it.



ز IS FOR

زیتون

zaytoon

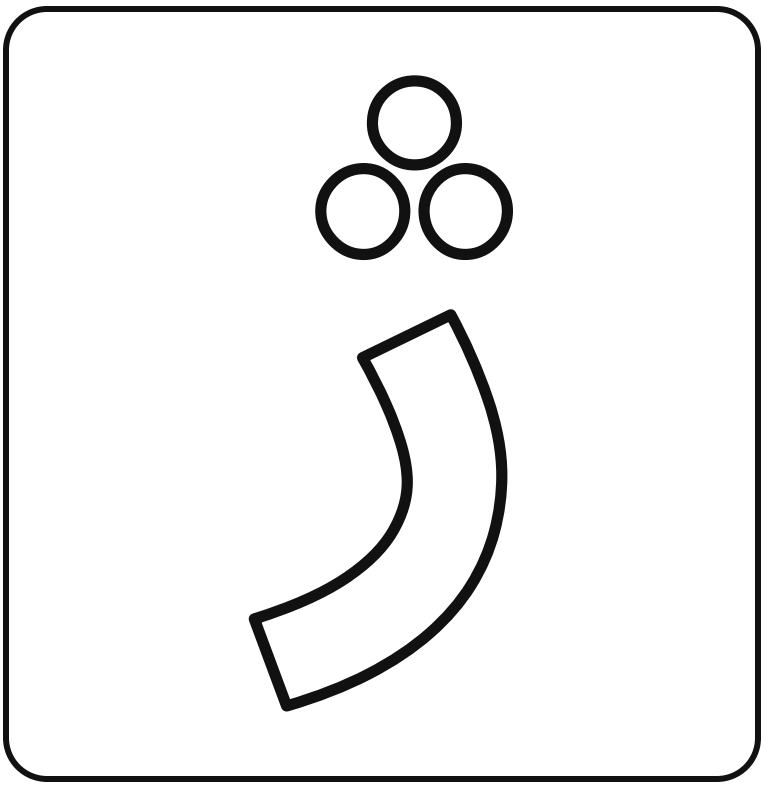
olive

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ

ز ز ز ز

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NAME · نوم

ژې

zhe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘zh’ like the ‘s’ in “measure”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ژ · after a letter ـژ

It never joins to the letter after it.



ژ IS FOR

ژاله

zhaala

hail

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ژ ژ ژ ژ

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NAME · نوم

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ze

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

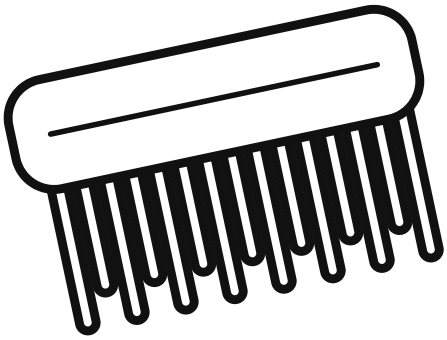
in the south a curled-back ‘zh’; in the north-east a ‘g’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ږ · after a letter ـږ

It never joins to the letter after it.

One dot above and one dot below.



ږ IS FOR

بږمنځ

zhmandz (gmanz)

comb

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ږ ږ ږ ږ

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س

NAME · نوم

سین

seen

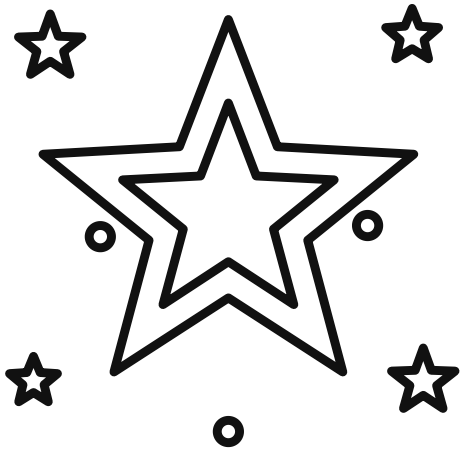
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

سـ ـسـ ـس

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



س IS FOR

ستوری

storay

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

س س س س س

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ش

NAME · نوم

شین

sheen

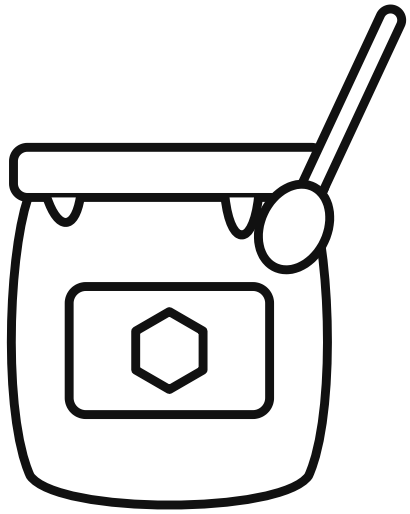
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “shoe”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

شـ ـشـ ـش

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ش IS FOR

شات

shaat

honey

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ش ش ش ش

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NAME · نوم

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ṣheen

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

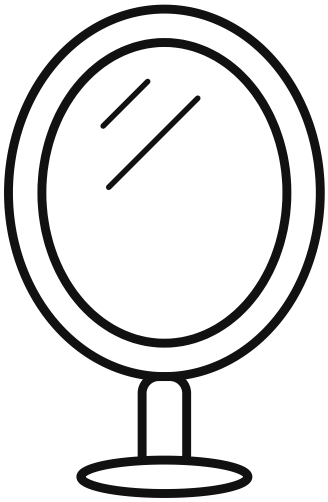
in the south a curled-back ‘sh’; in the north-east a ‘kh’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ښ ـښ ـښـ ښ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

One dot above and one dot below.



ښ IS FOR

ښیښه

shisha (khikha)

mirror, glass

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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ص

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صاد

swaad

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

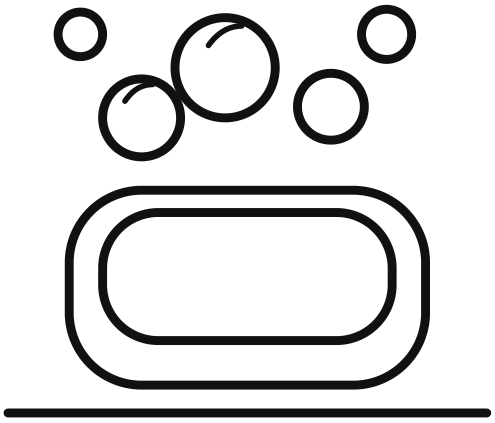
‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

صـ ـصـ ـص

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as س; it is used mostly in words from Arabic.



ص IS FOR

صابون

saaboon

soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ص ص ص ص

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ض

NAME · نوم

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zwaad

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

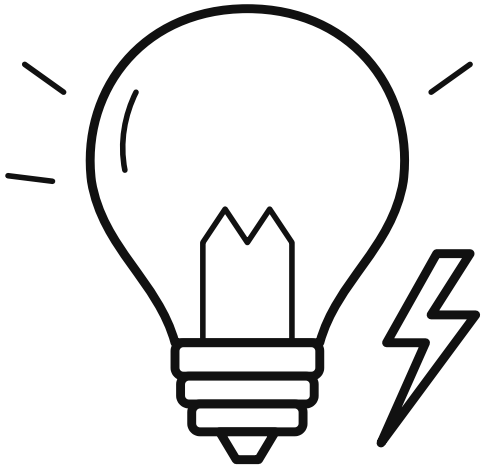
‘z’ as in “zoo”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ضـ ـضـ ـض

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as ز; it is used mostly in words from Arabic.



ض IS FOR

ضیا

ziyaa

light

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ

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ط

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toy

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

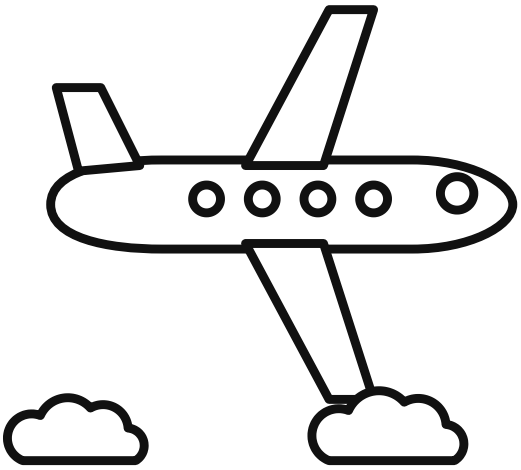
a soft ‘t’, like ت

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ط ـط ـط

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as ت; it is used mostly in words from Arabic.



ط IS FOR

طیاره

tayyaara

aeroplane

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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zoy

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

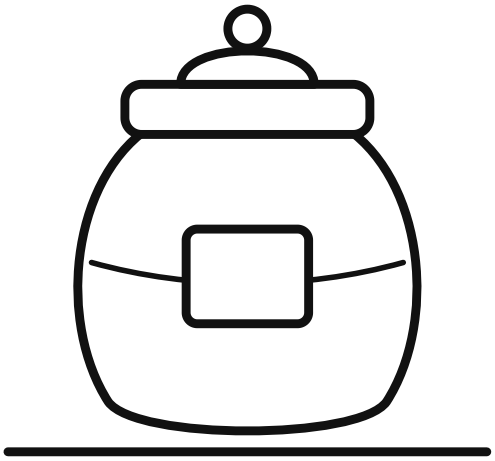
'z' as in "zoo"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ظـ ـظـ ـظ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as ز; it is used mostly in words from Arabic.



ظ IS FOR

ظرف

zarf

container, jar

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ

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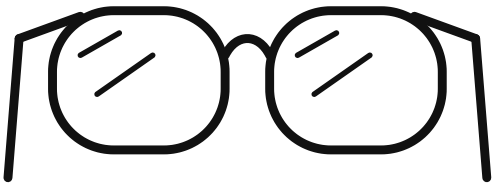
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

in Pashto, just the vowel next to it — in Arabic, a sound from deep in the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

عـ ـعـ ـع

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ع IS FOR

عینکې

aynake

glasses

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ

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NAME · نوم

غين

ghayn

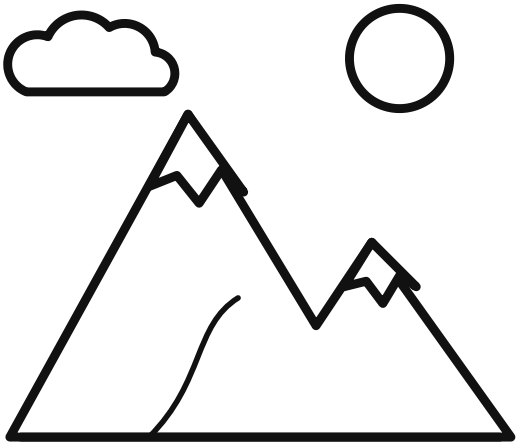
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft gargled ‘gh’ from the back of the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

غـ ـغـ ـغ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



غ IS FOR

غر

ghar

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

فـ ـفـ ـف

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ف IS FOR

فانوس

faanoos

lantern

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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ق

NAME · نوم

قاف

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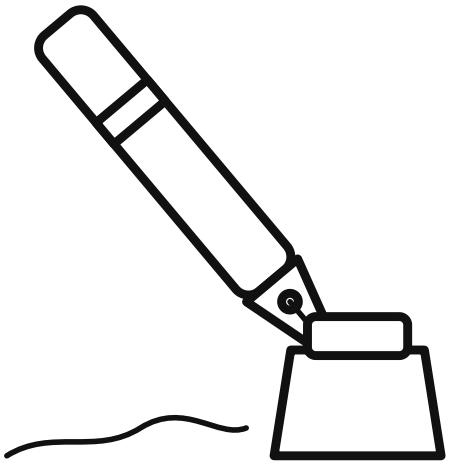
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘k’ said far back in the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

قـ ـقـ ـق

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ق IS FOR

قلم

qalam

pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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NAME · نوم

کاف

kaaf

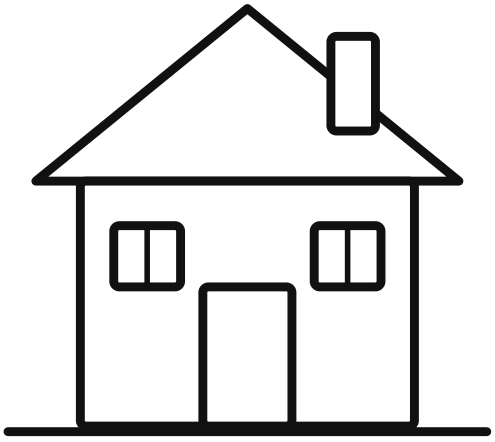
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ک ـکـ ـک

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ک IS FOR

کور

kor

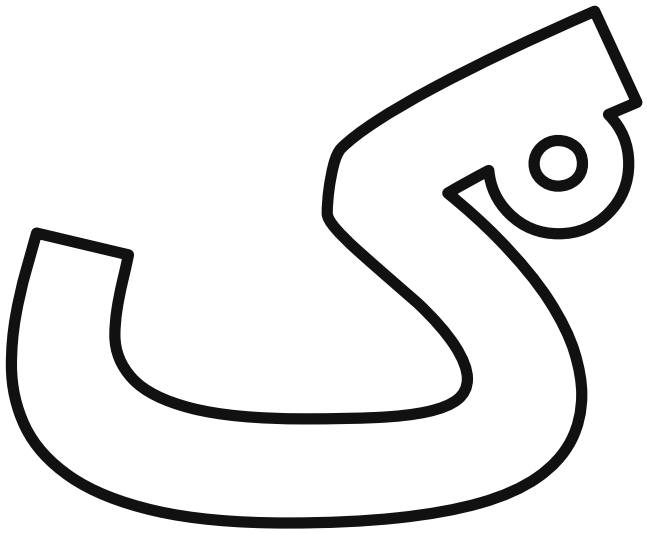
house, home

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ

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gaaf

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

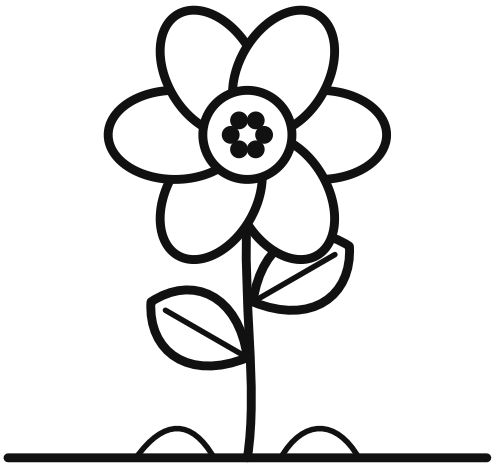
‘g’ as in “go”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ګ ـګـ ـګ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A little ring under it.



ک IS FOR

ګل

gul

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ولیکئ

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NAME · نوم

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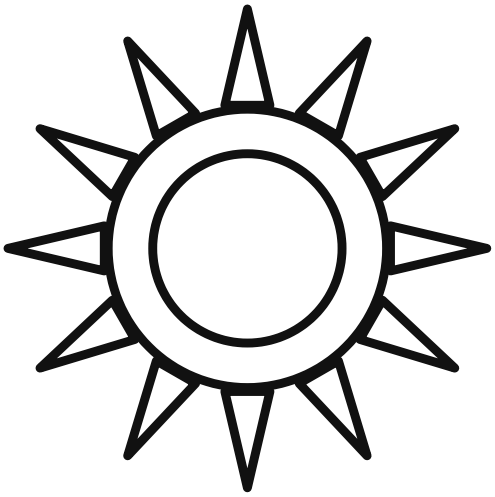
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ل ـلـ ـل

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ل IS FOR

لمر

lmar

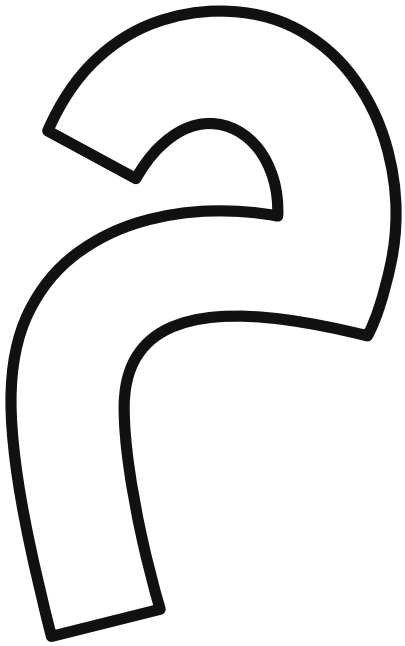
sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ل ل ل ل

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NAME · نوم

میم

meem

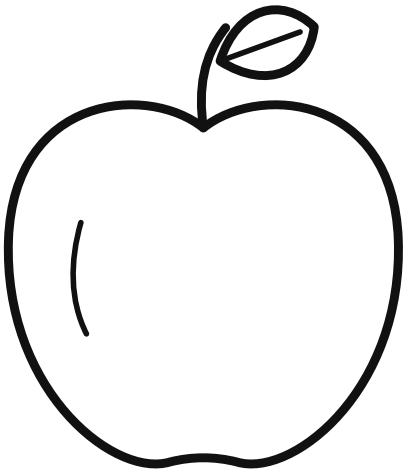
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

مـ ـمـ ـم

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



م IS FOR

منه

maṇa

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

م م م م

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ن

NAME · نوم

نون

noon

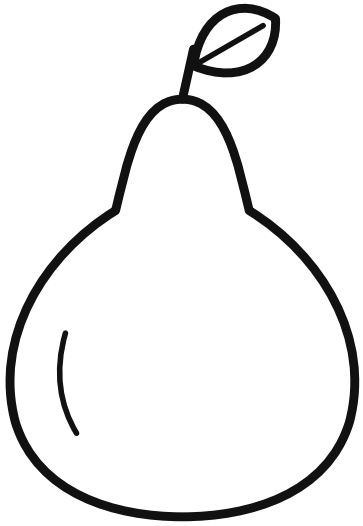
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ن ـنـ ـن

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ن IS FOR

ناک

naak

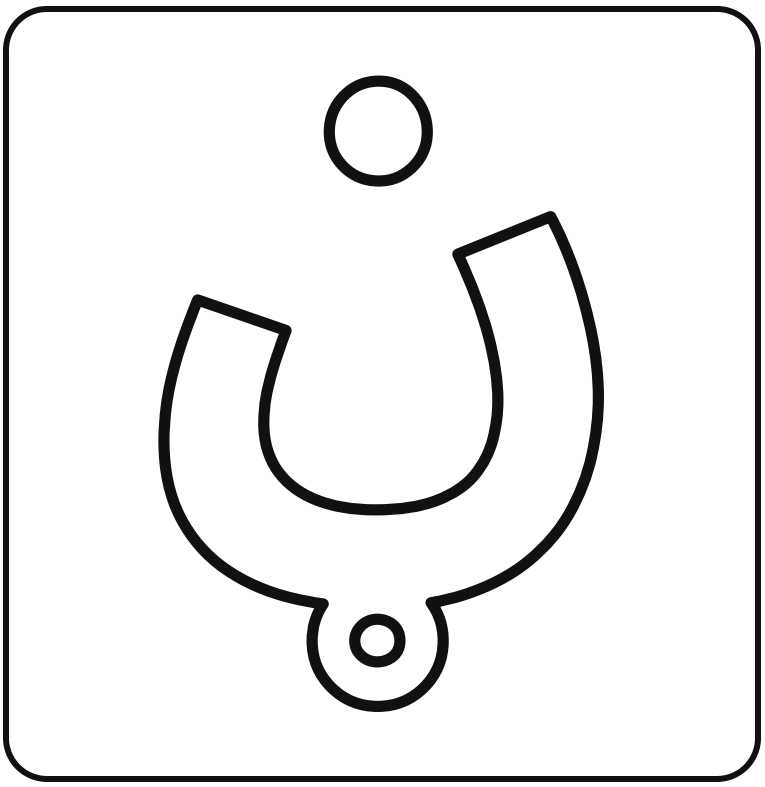
pear

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

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NAME · نوم

ڼون

ṇoon

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘n’ with the tongue curled back — it never starts a word

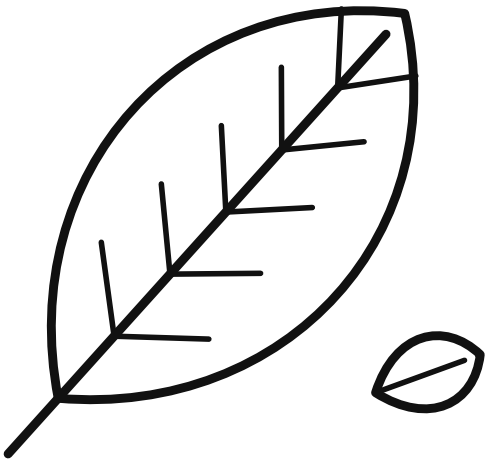
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ڼـ ـڼـ ـڼ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

The little ring under it means the tongue curls back.

Find ڼ in the middle of پاڼه!



ڼ IS FOR

پاڼه

paaṇa

leaf

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ڼ ڼ ڼ ڼ

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و

NAME · نوم

واو

waaw

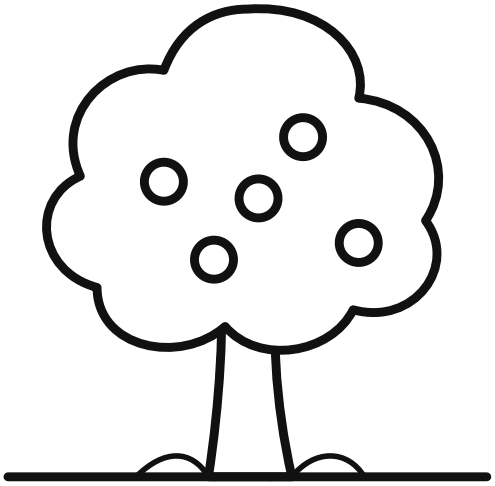
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'w' as in "water", or the long vowels 'oo' and 'o'

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **و** · after a letter **ـو**

It never joins to the letter after it.



و IS FOR

ونه

wana

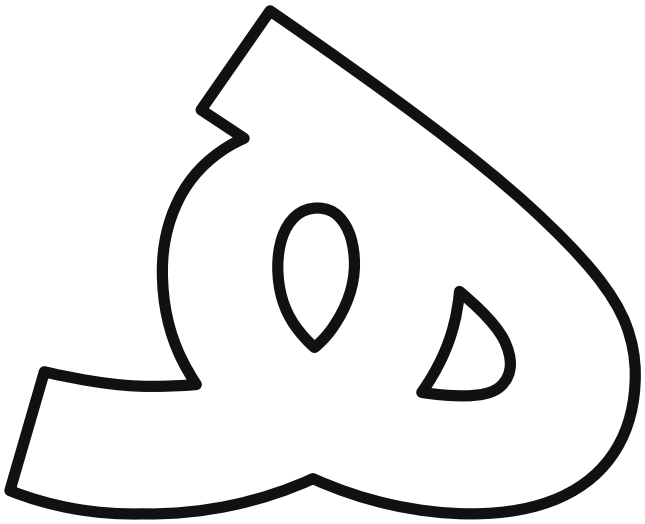
tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

و و و و

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NAME · نوم

هې

he

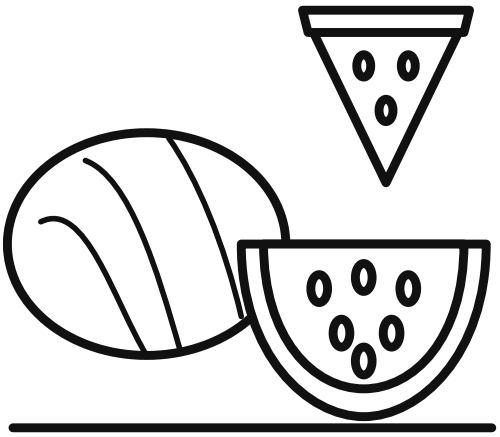
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”; at the end of a word it often says ‘a’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

هـ ـهـ ـه

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ه IS FOR

هندوانه

hindwaaṇa

watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ه ه ه ه

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NAME · نوم

معروفه يې

maaroofa ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

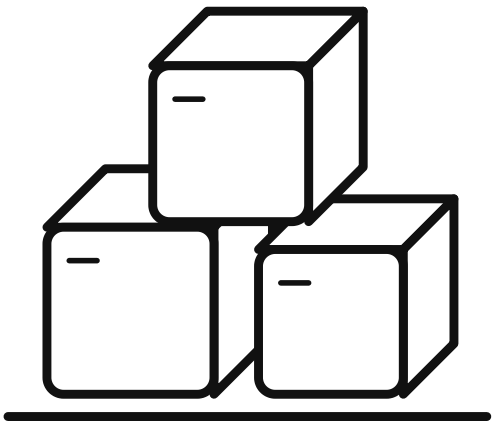
‘y’ as in “yes”, or the long vowel ‘ee’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

يـ ـيـ ـي

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Two dots below, even at the end of a word.



ي IS FOR

يخ

yakh

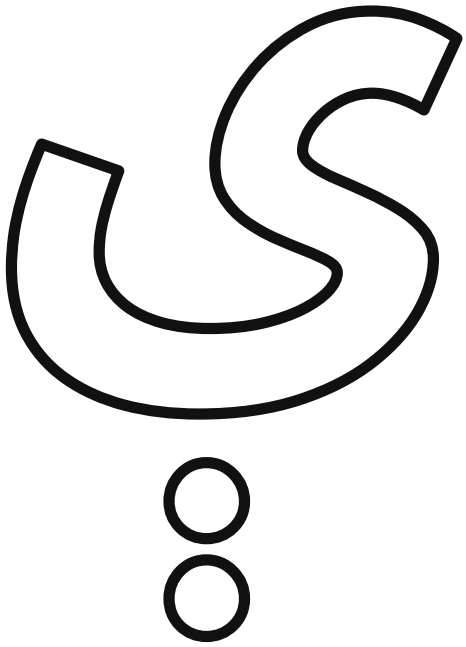
ice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ی ی ی ی

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NAME · نوم

مجهوله يې

majhoola ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'e' as in "they"

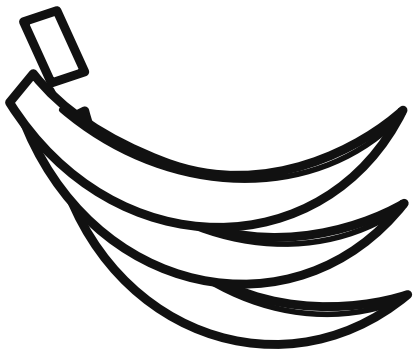
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ې ـېـ ـې

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Two dots below, one over the other.

Find ې in the middle of کېله!



ې IS FOR

کېله

kela

banana

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ



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ی

NAME · نوم

نرمه يې

narma ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

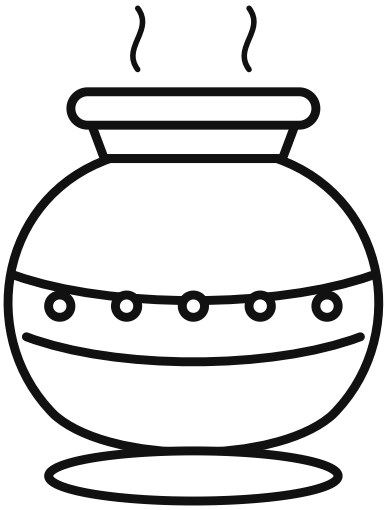
‘ay’ at the end of a word, as in “day”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

At the end of a word: ـی

No dots at the end of a word. Inside a word it looks just like یـ.

Look for ی at the end of منګی!



ی IS FOR

منګی

mangay

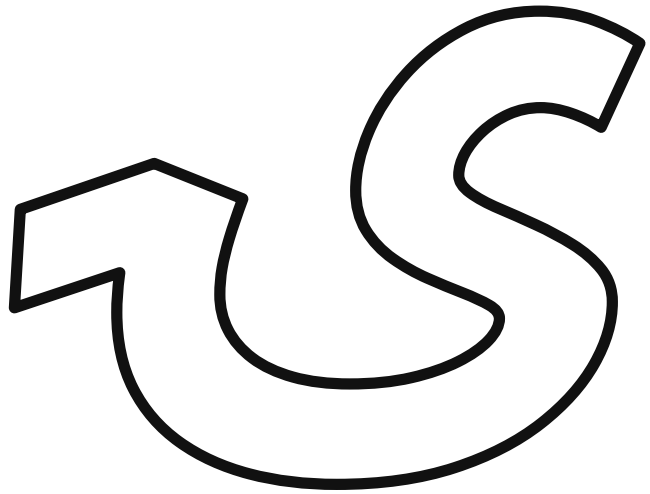
clay water jug

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ی ی ی ی

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NAME · نوم

ښځينه يې

shadzeena ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

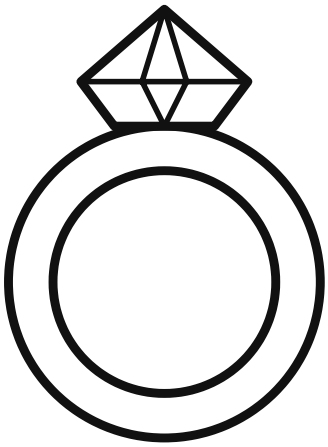
‘ay’ at the end of a word, in words for girls and things called “she”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

At the end of a word: ـې

It has a little tail, and it only comes at the end of a word.

Look for ـې at the end of کړې!



ې IS FOR

کړې

kaṛay

ring

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ



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ئ

NAME · نوم

فعلي يې

feli ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ay’ at the end of action words; inside a word, a little break in the voice

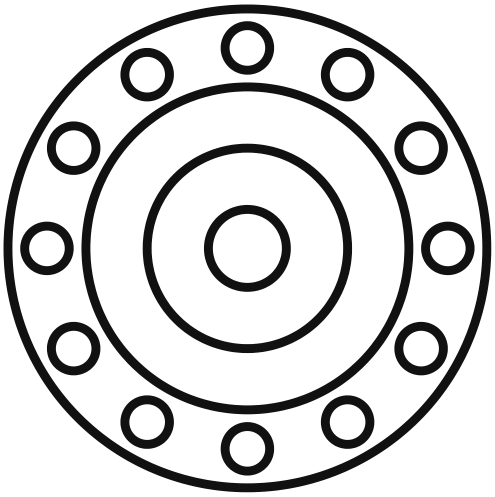
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ئ ـئـ ـئ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A little hamza on top.

Find ئ in the middle of دائره!



ئ IS FOR

دائره

daa’ira

circle

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · وليکئ

ئ ئ ئ ئ

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BONUS

Pashto numbers شمېرې *(shmere)*

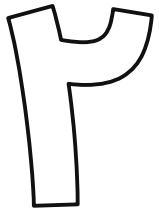
Color the numbers and count out loud in Pashto: *sifr*, *yaw*, *dwa*, *dre*...



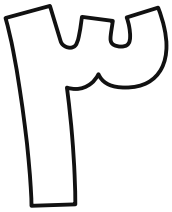
0
صفر
sifr
zero



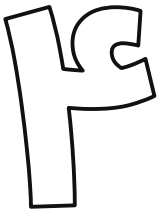
1
يو
yaw
one



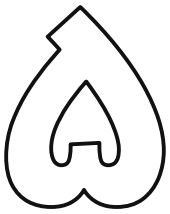
2
دوه
dwa
two



3
درې
dre
three



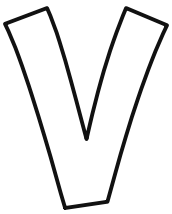
4
څلور
tsalor
four



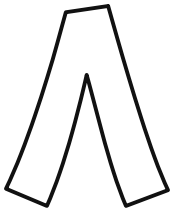
5
پنځه
pindza
five



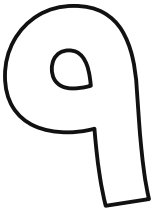
6
شپږ
shpazh
six



7
اووه
owa
seven



8
اته
ata
eight



9
نهه
naha
nine

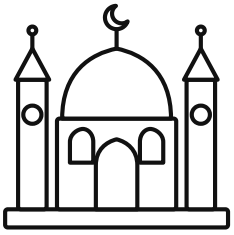
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LET'S TALK

My first Pashto words لومړني ټکي

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

السلام عليكم	*assalaamu alaykum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
وعليكم السلام	*wa alaykum assalaam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
زما نوم ... دی	*zmaa noom ... day* **My name is ...**
مننه	*manana* **Thank you**
جزاک الله خيراً	*jazaakallaahu khayran* **May Allah reward you with good**
مور · پلار	*mor · plaar* **Mother · Father**
ورور · خور	*wror · khor* **Brother · Sister**
هو · نه	*ho · na* **Yes · No**
زه پښتو زده کوم!	*za pashto zda kawam!* **I am learning Pashto!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

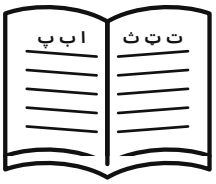
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

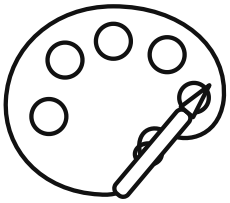
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International).

What's next?
You have met all **44 Pashto letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Pashto, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ماشاءالله! شاباس!

maashaa-allaah! shaabaas! — Well done, bravo!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 44 letters of the Pashto alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
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